

AORI

HANDMADE · IN RUNS OF TWELVE · HERAKLION, CRETE



AORI – DESIGN SYSTEM



ALL PRODUCT DATA PLACEHOLDER

WHAT THIS BOOK HOLDS

-
- 01 Philosophy — the workshop, and the voice it speaks in
 - 02 Logotype — the wordmark and its space
 - 03 Colour — grounds, pigments, and the two registers
 - 04 Typography — three faces, three jobs
 - 05 Illustration — the painted hand and the drawn register
 - 06 Iconography — the motif law and the functional set
 - 07 Shape, space and motion
 - 08 Application — the component layer
 - 09 In use — six channels, two products

AORI is a design system, not a brand: the rules are the system's, and the worked examples speak in the voice of its flagship case — a handmade-jewellery workshop in Heraklion, real on Instagram, its product data invented and labelled so. A harbourside taverna is built from the same tokens to prove the system carries across products.

Everything visual is watercolour and gouache on cotton paper. Corner radius is zero, there are no shadows, and depth is a 2px carbon rule, a 1px hairline, or a flat pigment field — never a blur.

| *We make twelve. When they are gone we make something else.*

THE VOICE IS A MAKER TALKING

PERSON

First person plural for the workshop, second person for the reader.
Never "AORI is proud to present".

CASING

Sentence case in prose. Uppercase only in the annotation voice — labels, buttons, metadata — where it is always tracked. Display headings are uppercase and tracked; body copy never is.

NUMBERS ARE LOAD-BEARING

Twelve in a run. Four left. Silver 925. Two working days. The brand's honesty is arithmetic; numbers are stated plainly and never rounded up for effect.

SCARCITY IS STATED, NEVER SOLD

"Four left of twelve", not "Selling fast". A closed run says "All twelve gone" and keeps its page.

NO EXCLAMATION MARKS. NO EMOJI.

Greek is reserved for the brand book; product surfaces are Latin only.

VERBATIM, FROM THE SYSTEM

Made by hand in Heraklion, in runs of twelve, and named after the places they came from.

Silver 925, hammered on the bench and left matte. Named for the beach below the village, where the water goes flat at six in the evening.

We will make more, but not the same.

ONE WORDMARK, AND ITS SUBORDINATES

THE ONLY MARK

The wordmark — a vector trace of painted lettering supplied by the workshop — is the only logo. No mark was invented for this system.

EMBLEMS SIT UNDER IT

The five painted emblem files contain no readable brand name; they are filed as emblems and always sit subordinate to the wordmark, never in its place.

COLOUR

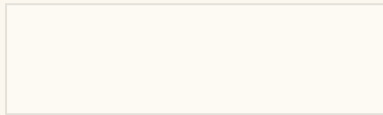
The wordmark runs in ink, terracotta, aegean, olive or paper — the palette and nothing outside it. Never on a photograph, never over a pattern at full strength.

SPACE AND MINIMUMS

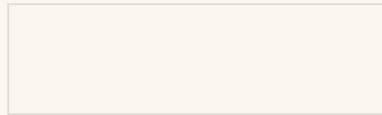
Clear space, minimum sizes, placement and the eight misuses are drawn in full at [guidelines/logotype.html](#).

GROUND — PLASTER, STOCK, STONE, CARBON

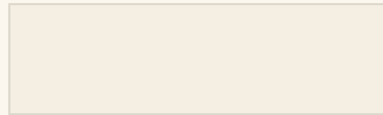
Lime plaster carries every page; toned stock is the paper the paintings are drawn on; stone is the clerical register; carbon is fresco black, thinned. Laid flat and opaque, never tinted, never gradiented.



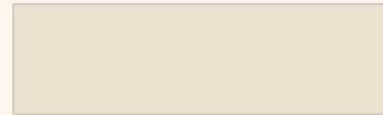
PAPER-100
#FDFAF4



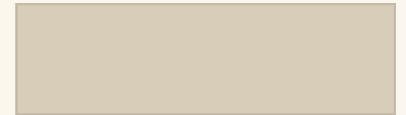
PAPER-200 · THE PAGE
#FBF7EF



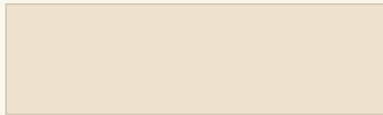
PAPER-300
#F5EFE3



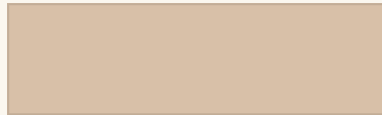
PAPER-400
#EBE2D2



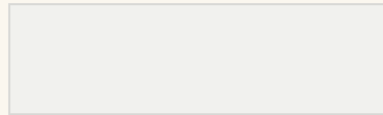
PAPER-500
#D8CDB8



STOCK-100 · THE MOUNT
#EFE3CF



STOCK-200
#D8C0A8



LEDGER-100 · STONE
#F1F1EE



LEDGER-INK
#4A5A52



INK-900 · CARBON
#2A2622

Maximum two background colours in any one document. The stone register takes anything administrative — sizing, shipping, order status, specification — with form-green ink and 1px hairlines.

THIRTEEN PIGMENTS, OUT OF THE PAINTINGS

Sampled by frequency from the plates themselves. Four to six carry a composition; never more. **Terracotta acts, aegean links, saffron highlights.**



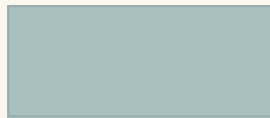
AEGEAN
#1890A8



WATER
#006078



SHALLOW
#78C0C0



HAZE
#A8C0C0



TERRACOTTA
#C05A28



CLAY
#A87860



RUST
#8A3A22



SAFFRON
#C0A860



OCHRE
#907848



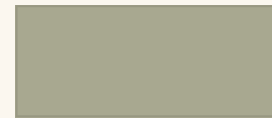
OLIVE
#5F7A46



FOREST
#34513C



UMBER
#6B4426



SLATE
#A8A890

METALS — MATTE, NEVER A GRADIENT, NEVER A SHINE



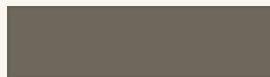
GOLD
#C0A860



GOLD-DEEP
#907848



SILVER
#A8A890



SILVER-OXIDE
#6E675C



BRONZE
#A87860

THE PIGMENT MARKS, THE INK SPEAKS

ACTION — EACH THROUGH ITS INK CUT

		
ACCENT #B04E20 · 4.97:1	ACCENT-HOVER #A84A1E · 5.36:1	ACCENT-PRESS #8A3A22 · 7.25:1
		
LINK #117487 · 5.08:1	LINK-HOVER · FOCUS #006078 · 6.67:1	LINK-VISITED #6B4426 · 7.92:1

Hover darkens one step — the same direction as press. A pigment never lightens under the pointer. Ratios are measured against the page and enforced by `tools/check_contrast.py` on every run.

STATUS — PIGMENT FOR MARKS, INK FOR WORDS

			
STOP	WARM	CALM	GO
			
STOP-INK · 7.25:1	WARM-INK · 4.95:1	CALM-INK · 5.08:1	GO-INK · 8.23:1

Wherever a status colour becomes text — a notice label, an error line, a tag — it takes its ink cut, which clears 4.5:1 on paper. The full pigments stay on rules, fills and stamps, where 3:1 is the bar.

THREE FACES, THREE JOBS

AΩ

GFS DIDOT — DISPLAY

Names, headings, prices. Uppercase, tracked .09–.14em. Greek-capable, which is why it won.

PSILORITIS · 185 €

Aa

COMMISSIONER — ANNOTATION & UI

Labels, buttons, metadata, nav. Always uppercase, tracked .055–.14em, weight 600.

FOUR LEFT OF TWELVE · ADD TO BAG

Aa

SOURCE SERIF 4 — BODY

Prose, descriptions, form values. Sentence case, 15–17px, line-height 1.7–1.75.

Hammered on the bench and left matte,
named for the beach below the village.

The scale runs 11 / 13 / 15 / 17 / 20 / 25 / 32 / 42 / 58 / 80 / 112px. Wide tracking on display type is the loudest signal in the brand; body copy is never tracked and never uppercase.

Minimums: 24px type in a 1920×1080 slide, 12pt in print, 44px hit targets on touch surfaces. All three faces are Google-hosted substitutions until licensed files arrive — the swap happens in `tokens/fonts.css` alone.

THE PAINTED HAND



COVE



TAVERNA



GENERATIONS



NIGHT

Saturated fields held inside a drawn contour, the paper reading through the lighter passages, nothing opaque white, nothing greyed to recede. The full plate — 23 places, figures and still lifes — mounts on toned stock with a 5px unpainted margin, so it never floats.

A painting opens the site; a photograph never does. Collection tiles are paintings (a tile is a *place*); product tiles and galleries are photographs. The full image-jobs table is at guidelines/image-jobs.html; the photography route itself is still an open decision, documented with four costed options in the specification.

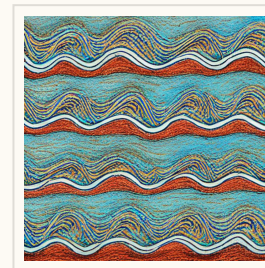
MOTIFS ARE CIRCLES, PATTERNS ARE SQUARES

THE SIX LIFTED DETAILS — DECORATION WITH PROVENANCE

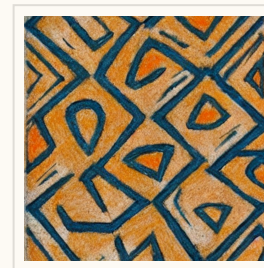


Each is cut out of a finished painting and belongs to a place — using one is a claim about which place a page is about. Minimum 40px, one per page, never redrawn, never a control.

THREE PATTERNS, THREE STRENGTHS



WAVE



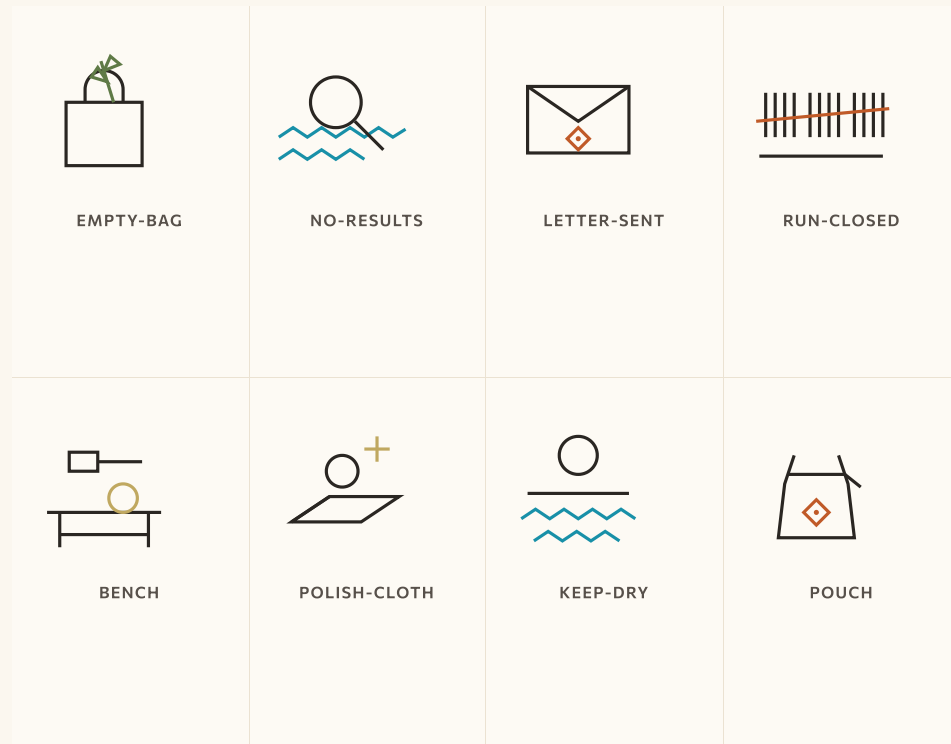
SPIRAL



OLIVE

Full strength for packaging and one hero band; 30% for section grounds; 8% behind long prose — applied as a ::before layer so the opacity never touches the text. Never two patterns on one screen.

THE DRAWN REGISTER



THE THIRD JOB OF THE ONE HAND

Eight bench drawings on a 96px grid at the icons' 2px carbon rule, one pigment accent each. Not paintings — they claim no provenance from the plates.

SERVICE, NOT ROMANCE

Empty states, care and sizing instructions, transactional email. A drawing never opens a page and never sits beside a painted plate — the painting wins.

WORDS BESIDE IT

Like an icon, a drawing never carries meaning alone: the annotation line under it says the thing plainly. "All twelve gone."

THE MOTIF LAW HOLDS

No drawn octopus, no drawn sun, no drawn spiral. Motifs stay paintings; drawings depict objects from the bench and the shop.

SIXTEEN MARKS, ONE CONSTRUCTION

 SEARCH	 BAG	 ACCOUNT	 FILTER	 CLOSE	 ARROW-L	 ARROW-R	 PLUS
 MINUS	 CHECK	 RULER	 PACKAGE	 SEAL	 MAIL	 PIN	 SPARKLE

CONSTRUCTION

24px grid, 16px keystone, the system's 2px carbon rule: butt caps, mitre joins, square corners, currentColor. One deliberate solid — the seal's centre dot.

SIZES

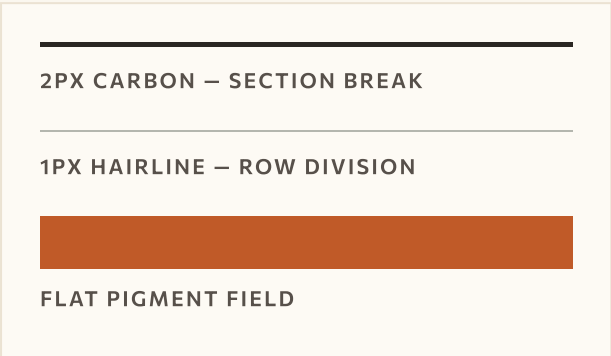
Rendered at 24px, or 16px in the clerical register; never above 40px.

NEVER ALONE, NEVER DECORATING

An icon never carries meaning alone — the word sits beside it — and an icon never decorates. Motifs stay paintings; icons do the interface jobs; the two never trade.

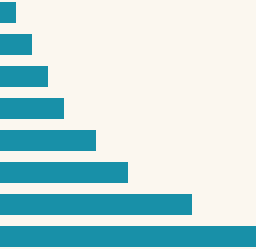
SQUARE, SPACIOUS, NEARLY STILL

EDGE & DEPTH



Corner radius is zero, everywhere. No shadows, no blur — the one exception is a gradient scrim over a hero painting so white type stays legible.

SPACE — 4PX BASE



4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64 · 96 · 128 · 176. Page margins are deliberately large — the paintings are surrounded by unpainted paper, and the layout should be too. Prose measures 62ch.

MOTION — FROM PRINT

INSTANT	80ms
FAST	140ms
BASE	220ms
SLOW	420ms
PAGE	700ms

Opacity and position only. No bounce, no spring, no scale-on-hover, no parallax. Reduced motion collapses every duration to zero. Focus is a 2px deep-water outline, offset 3px, never removed.

THE COMPONENT LAYER

ACTIONS

ADD TO BAG

SIZING GUIDE

[READ HOW IT IS MADE](#)

FORM STOCK

RING SIZE

54 — or a string and a ruler

One free resize, always.

NOTICE

SOLD OUT

Twelve made. All twelve gone. We will make more, but not the same.

Twenty React components in components/ — core, content, forms, feedback, navigation — each with a typed interface and a `.prompt.md` contract for agent use, so generated pages inherit the rules.

BEHAVIOUR IS PART OF THE SPEC

Dialogs trap focus, close on Escape and return focus to the opener. Tabs run the automatic-activation keyboard pattern. Errors are spoken — `aria-invalid`, described-by wiring, rust ink at 7.25:1 — never just painted.

HOVER DARKENS

One step, the same direction as press. Nothing scales, nothing lifts, nothing casts.

THE GATE HOLDS THE LINE

Every colour role a component uses is a measured pair in `tools/check_contrast.py`; a token edit that breaks one fails the build.



And a second product to prove the point: a harbourside taverna website built with nothing reskinned ([cases/taverna-home.html](#)). The palette came from the paintings; everything else carried unchanged.



This book is generated from the living system — tokens, guidelines and cases in the repository are the source of truth, and the contrast gate measures every colour role on every run. The workshop is real; every collection, price and run count shown is invented and labelled placeholder.

Repository: github.com/aposfys/aori-design-system

Source: [docs/brandbook/book.html](#) · regenerate the PDF from it after any token change.